



Core POS

Installation & Multi-Till LAN Setup Guide

Version 1.2

Covers: single-machine install, Main Server
setup,
Workstation setup, verification &
troubleshooting

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1. Overview

Core POS is a self-contained, offline-first point-of-sale system. Every install bundles its own PHP backend, database engine (MariaDB), and desktop app (Electron) — no internet connection or external server is required to run a single till.

For shops running more than one till, Core also supports a **shared-database mode**: one machine (the **Main Server**) hosts the database, and every other till (a **Workstation**) connects to it over your local network (LAN). Each Workstation still runs its own local backend and app — only the database is centralized — so a till that briefly loses its network connection keeps working and queues sales locally, syncing automatically once the connection is restored.

```
Main Server (e.g. 192.168.1.10)
+-- MariaDB database (port 3307, shared over the LAN)
+-- PHP backend      (own local install)
+-- Electron POS app (own local install)

Workstation 2, 3, 4 ...
+-- PHP backend      (own local install) ---> talks to 192.168.1.10
+-- Electron POS app (own local install)
```

Not running multiple tills? Skip straight to Section 3 (Standard Install) and ignore the Main Server / Workstation steps entirely — a single-machine install needs no extra choices.

2. Before You Start

System requirements (every machine)

Requirement	Detail
Operating System	Windows 10 version 1809 (build 17763) or later, or Windows 11
Permissions	Administrator account (the installer requires admin rights)
Disk space	~500 MB free
Network (multi-till only)	All tills on the same LAN/subnet, or routed with the database port reachable

What you'll need

- The installer file: `Core-Setup-1.2.exe`
- For a multi-till setup: know which physical machine will be the **Main Server** (ideally one that stays powered on and connected, e.g. the back-office PC) before you start installing on any till

3. Standard Install (Single Machine)

Use this for a single till with no other machines to connect. This is the default flow.

- 1 Run `Core-Setup-1.2.exe` as Administrator.
- 2 Follow the setup wizard (choose install location, desktop shortcut option, etc.) and click Install.
- 3 A black configuration window opens automatically and runs through: PHP setup, installing the local database, creating the database and app user, writing configuration, applying migrations and default data, and a final startup smoke test.
- 4 When it asks "*Is this machine the MAIN SERVER or a WORKSTATION?*", just press **Enter** (defaults to Main Server) — this is correct even for a single standalone till.
- 5 When setup finishes, it prints the default login and asks you to press Enter to close the window.
- 6 Double-click **Core** on the Desktop to launch.

Default login	
Username	admin
Password	Admin@123

Change the default password after your first login, from Settings → Staff.

4. Multi-Till LAN Setup — Overview

If you're setting up several tills that should all see the same products, stock, sales and customers, install in this order:

1. **Install the Main Server first** — exactly one machine. See Section 5.
2. **Install every Workstation after that** — every other till, one at a time. See Section 6.

Order matters. A Workstation install will fail (with a clear error) if it can't reach a Main Server, so the Main Server must be fully set up and running before you install any Workstation.

5. Step A — Install the Main Server

Do this once, on the machine that will hold the shared database.

1. **1** Run `Core-Setup-1.2.exe` as Administrator on this machine and follow the wizard as normal.
2. **2** When the configuration window asks the role question, choose **[1] Main Server** (press **1** then Enter, or just Enter since it's the default).
3. **3** Setup proceeds as a standard install, plus it additionally:
 - Opens the local database to listen on the network (not just this machine)
 - Grants the app's database user access from other machines on the LAN
 - Opens a Windows Firewall rule for the database port (`3307`)
4. **4** At the end, setup prints this machine's **network address(es)**, e.g.:

```
This machine's network address(es) - use one of these when installing
Core as a Workstation on other tills:
192.168.1.10
```

Write this address down — you'll enter it on every Workstation.

5. **5** Press Enter to close, then launch **Core** from the Desktop shortcut to confirm it opens normally.

Tip: give this machine a static IP address or a DHCP reservation on your router, so its address doesn't change later and break the Workstations' connection.

6. Step B — Install Each Workstation

Repeat this on every other till, once the Main Server (Section 5) is running.

1. **1** Run `Core-Setup-1.2.exe` as Administrator on the Workstation machine and follow the wizard as normal.
2. **2** When asked the role question, choose **[2] Workstation** (type `2` then Enter).
3. **3** When prompted, enter the Main Server's address you wrote down in Step A (e.g. `192.168.1.10`). Press Enter to accept the default database port (`3307`) unless you changed it.
4. **4** Setup connects to the shared database (no local database is installed on this machine), skips schema/seed setup (the Main Server already did that), writes configuration, and runs the same startup smoke test.
5. **5** When finished, it confirms which shared database this Workstation is using. Press Enter to close, then launch **Core** from the Desktop shortcut.
6. **6** Log in with the same admin credentials used on the Main Server — it's the same shared database, so the same users/products/stock are already there.

Unattended / scripted installs

Both roles can be supplied as command-line parameters to skip the interactive prompts:

```
REM Main Server
powershell -File install.ps1 -AppDir C:\POS -ServerMode main
```

```
REM Workstation
powershell -File install.ps1 -AppDir C:\POS -ServerMode workstation -ServerHost 192.168.1.10 -ServerPort 3307
```


7. Verifying the Connection

After installing a Workstation, confirm it's really sharing data with the Main Server:

1. On the Main Server, ring up a test sale or add a test product.
2. On the Workstation, open Core and check that same product/sale appears (e.g. in Products, or Sales History).
3. Try it in reverse too — changes made on a Workstation should appear on the Main Server and any other Workstation.

If a Workstation was briefly disconnected from the network while a sale was made, that sale is queued locally and syncs automatically once the connection returns — no data is lost.

8. Day-to-Day Operation

Scenario	What happens
Main Server is on, network is fine	Everything works normally on every till
A Workstation loses network briefly	That till keeps taking sales, queues them locally, syncs once reconnected
Main Server is off / unreachable	Workstations cannot reach the shared database until it's back; keep the Main Server powered on and connected during trading hours
Main Server's IP address changes	Workstations will lose the connection; either fix the Main Server's IP (recommended: static/reserved) or re-run each Workstation install pointing at the new address

9. Backups

Take backups from **Settings** → **Backups** — but only from the **Main Server**. Workstations have no local database to back up (there's nothing there to dump), since they're only reading/writing the Main Server's shared database. Backing up from the Main Server captures everyone's data in one place.

10. Troubleshooting

A Workstation install fails to connect during setup

The installer will refuse to continue and show a specific error. Check:

- The Main Server machine is powered on, and Core was installed there as **Main Server** (not Workstation)
- Both machines are on the same network/subnet
- You typed the correct IP address and port
- Windows Firewall on the Main Server allows port 3307 — the Main Server installer opens this automatically, but third-party antivirus/firewall software can override it
- Both machines' network connections are set to **Private** (not **Public**) in Windows network settings — the firewall rule only allows Private and Domain network profiles

Core app won't open on a Workstation

If the Main Server is temporarily unreachable, the Core app will still open (it no longer depends on the database being reachable just to launch) — you'll see connectivity messages inside the app instead. If the app doesn't open at all, check the log at `C:\POS\backend\storage\logs\server.log` on that Workstation.

General diagnostics

Run `installer\diagnose.ps1` (from the project source) or check `C:\POS\backend\storage\logs\laravel.log` for backend errors.

11. Updating / Uninstalling

Re-running `Core-Setup-1.2.exe` on a machine that already has Core installed performs an update: existing data and login credentials are preserved (a database backup is taken automatically before an update on the Main Server). To uninstall, use "Uninstall Core" from the Start Menu or Windows Settings → Apps.

When updating a Main Server, its database is backed up automatically before any schema changes are applied. When updating a Workstation, no local backup is needed since it holds no local data — the Main Server's backup already covers everyone's data.